

Great Expectations for the Wolkovich Lab

August 17, 2026

1 Why are you giving me this?

The Temporal Ecology Lab (aka ‘the Wolkovich lab’) is fortunate enough to be a pretty happy, productive and efficient place to be most of the time (IMHO). The reason for this is the people—who are generally amazing team members.

Sometimes, how to be an amazing team member is not obvious to everyone though. So to be clear, I have written up a list of what I expect. Most of these tasks should be easy for you and effectively are my way of explaining what I see as a good lab member. That said, everyone is different and many things can come up over someone’s time in the lab, so think of these as general guidelines and if you find times in your career you cannot meet all the expectations—just reach out to me (Lizzie) to discuss.

2 Lab expectations

- Follow our shared lab values.
- Attend lab meetings (happily).
- Attend scrum and give weekly updates.
- Follow the lab’s data management plan, including how you manage metadata and in backing up all your data.
- Schedule meetings with Lizzie as needed. Please ask for help when you need it.
- Plan for a usual two-week turnaround on grants, drafts, letters etc. given to or requested from Lizzie. Depending on the request and Lizzie’s schedule it could be longer.
- Exploit the seminar resources around you. Aim to attend at least one talk a week of the following: Biodiversity Seminar Series (Wednesdays at noon); Faculty of Forestry Seminar series (not every week, but Tuesdays at noon); Departmental Seminar series (Forest & Conservation Sciences); Botany Seminar Series (Tuesdays at 12:30)
- Attend all talks by lab-invited speakers and sign up to meet with them.
- Help out as requested in the lab. The lab has a variety of resources/events that make the lab happier and more productive but keeping these things running requires small commitments from all lab members.

During your time in the lab you’ll be asked to pitch in on various lab tasks and manage various resources. Some examples include: keeping the lab vehicle on top of its inspections;

helping design, collect seeds or aid big experiments or long-term research; bring snacks to lab meeting, helping schedule invited speakers, etc.. Please help when asked to contribute to keeping the lab running well.

- Help out in other ways, not always requested, but needed in the lab. If you see something that needs doing (e.g., scheduling a lab cleanup day, or getting gas for the grills before a BBQ), please offer to do it, or just do it (depending on what it is).
- Be especially considerate of the administrative staff (the folks who work in the FCS office, the financial staff etc.). This includes: replying to any emails they personally send you promptly and politely, submitting your receipts within a reasonable timeframe with all the information filled out clearly (and scan your receipts so that they are not giant files), and generally remembering that they are working to help us all in the lab, so treating them poorly in any way reflects poorly on all of us.
- Share your skills and knowledge and be open to learning from your peers.
- Write your documents in **LaTeX** (or txt or rtf for quicker documents).
- Organize all code with **git** and use github to share code.
- Check in with Lizzie before booking your field season travel (and other major travel).
- Adjust your schedule to make yourself the most productive (and hopefully) efficient, but plan to be on-campus most work days for at least 6 hours.
- Check before you schedule holiday time of beyond a few days and be sure to add it to the lab calendar.
- Follow lab guidelines on writing.
- Follow lab guidelines on the use of generative AI and disclosure of your use of it more broadly.
- Share lab resources well. If multiple people need the same resource try to make it work, and if you plan to monopolize a resource for a while, bring it up at scrum first.
- Back up your computer! Pester to Lizzie to finalize a lab resource for this.
- Ask Lizzie about the current computer policy—there is always \$400 CAD available for monitors and peripherals. If you need a laptop we can usually find a budget for one, but it does become UBC property when you leave.
- Be productive and happy! Look for ways to make the lab a better place for others and suggest ways to make it better for you.